

GET THE SWORD!

The following combat encounter is intended for **five level 1 heroes**. You can modify the details of this encounter as you see fit, replacing any of the named concepts with elements from your own campaign.

Race to the Sword

The heroes are tasked by an old widow to venture into the Abby Woods and retrieve the sword of her late husband. She wants to bring the sword home as soon as possible, as she's learned that a gang of radenwights are looking for it.

The gang is led by Cicero the Pied Viper, a white and brown mottled radenwight sellsword. Cicero goes out of his way to take the jobs that'll keep his crew fed for weeks, and his client promised him a lot of money for the sword.

The heroes and radenwights don't realize that the sword seals away an old rift into the Abyssal Waste. The widow is secretly a dark magician tricking both parties as she seeks to undo the knight's seal and reclaim her demonic forces. By pitting the heroes against Cicero, she's nearly guaranteed to reopen the rift.

It'll be up to the heroes to thwart the magician's plan before the sword is pulled or curb the demons before people get hurt.

Abby Woods Clearing

When the heroes reach the woods, provide the following information:

- ♦ "Spring trees gently sway in the breeze, offering little cover to the sun-kissed grass below."
- ♦ "Muddy water pools gently into the clearing, alive with the chatter of frogs and insects."
- ♦ "Rubble and moss are the only evidence of the ancient temple that once stood here."
- ♦ "A longsword, rusted and chipped, pierces a stone sigil at the heart of the clearing."

When the heroes reach the clearing, twelve **radenwight scraggers**, three **radenwight ratcrobat**s, and **Cicero** (a radenwight piper) come into view. On making eye contact with the heroes, they immediately split up to hold off the heroes while Cicero goes after the sword.

Muddy Water

The waters are considered difficult terrain. The radenwights prefer to not get their fur wet.

Old Sword

The sword is holding back an abyssal rift that craves blood and violence. If the sword is removed from the ground, an abyssal rift unfolds on the ground and demons start to pour out. Four frenzieds and three ruinants appear along the cliffside and attack everything in sight. Any frenzieds and ruinants that were destroyed are replaced at the start of each round until the rift is destroyed.

The rift is a size 1M immovable object that has 25 Stamina, damage immunity 2, and holy weakness 5. A creature who has the Magic or Psionics skill can make a **Reason test** or **Intuition test** as a maneuver while adjacent to the rift to destabilize and destroy it.

≤11 The rift regains 5 Stamina.

12-16 The rift takes 5 damage.

17+ The rift takes 13 damage.

Encounter Credits

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Radenwight Ratcrobat Art: Matheus Graef

Groups

Group	Creatures
1	One radenwight ratcrobat (captain) Four radenwight scraggers (minion squad)
2	One radenwight ratcrobat (captain) Four radenwight scraggers (minion squad)
3	One radenwight ratcrobat (captain) Four radenwight scraggers (minion squad)
4	Cicero

Add the following groups when the demons appear:

Group	Creatures
5	One ruinant (captain) Four frenzieds (minion squad)
6	Two ruinants

Adjusting the Encounter

Heroes	Adjustments
3	Remove three radenwight ratcrobat s.
4	Remove one group of four radenwight scraggers and one radenwight ratcrobat .
6	Add one group featuring four radenwight scraggers and one radenwight ratcrobat .

Tactics

Two ratcrobat and their scraggers take point, surrounding the heroes and holding their attention. Cicero and the remaining radenwights head toward the sword as fast as they can. Cicero doesn't take the sword himself, choosing to use Piercing Trill and Musical Suggestion to position his allies closer to the sword and the heroes further away. If a radenwight gets the sword, they make a break for the South of the map and toss the sword to the nearest ally whenever they get cornered.

The radenwights will fight for the sword while it's still in the ground, but the situation changes when demons appear. Nobody said nothing about no demons. The radenwights will choose to drop the sword and run if it's clear they won't survive.

Ending the Encounter

The heroes' main objective is taking the sword. The heroes earn 1 Victory each when they leave with the sword, and a second Victory if they choose to destroy the abyssal rift.

The heroes fail if the radenwights escape with the sword, the heroes are killed, or the heroes flee without the sword while the demons are active.

When the heroes return, the magician in her widow disguise only stays around long enough to take the sword back and shrugs off the demons now filling the woods. The widow is long gone if the abyssal rift is destroyed, leaving behind only magical scorch marks.

Rewards

The sword is rendered ordinary until the rift is destroyed. If the heroes return the sword without dealing with the rift, the old widow will gladly take the sword and reward the heroes with three **Healing Potions** before escaping.

Once the rift is gone, the sword regains a sliver of power and has the following 1st-Level Weapon Enhancement:

Thundering I: Whenever you deal rolled damage to a creature using this weapon, you can push that creature 1 square after any other effects of the ability used resolve.



Radenwight Malice

Malice Feature

At the start of any radenwight's turn, you can spend malice to activate one of the following features.

✂️ Trouser Cut 2d10 + 2

Melee, Strike, Weapon

Melee 1

≤11 7 damage; push 3

12-16 10 damage; push 3; taunted (EoT)

17+ 13 damage; push 5; taunted (EoT)

Effect: If a target is wearing clothing covering the lower half of their body, they must use a maneuver to pull that clothing up before they can move.

Special: This ability can't be used by a minion.

3 Malice

Main Action

One creature

🎵 Rally the Rodents

7 Malice

A radenwight uses music to coordinate living rats, forming a 10 wall of rats scurrying atop one another into unoccupied spaces anywhere on the encounter map. The wall doesn't block line of effect for radenwights and their allies, but it does for other creatures, as the rats coordinate their movements with the radenwights. Each square of the wall has 10 Stamina.

If the last radenwight in the encounter dies and the wall is still standing, the rats let out a hideous screech as they disperse. Each enemy on the encounter map makes an **Intuition test**.

≤11 7 sonic damage; the target can't take a respite activity during their next respite

12-16 5 sonic damage

17+ No effect

Demon Malice

Malice Feature

At the start of any demon's turn, you can spend malice to activate one of the following features.

★ Soul Burn

3 Malice

Each demon acting this turn has a double edge on abilities.

🌀 Abyssal Evolution

7 Malice

A demon minion of your choice transforms into a non-minion horde demon of the same level.

Radenwight Scrapper

Humanoid, Radenwight

Level 1 Minion Defender

EV 3 for four minions

1S
Size

5
Speed

5
Stamina

1
Stability

1
Free Strike

Immunity: —
Movement: Climb

Weakness: —
With Captain: +2 bonus to melee distance

Might -1

Agility +1

Reason 0

Intuition 0

Presence +2

✂️ Buckler Bash 2d10 + 2

Charge, Melee, Strike, Weapon

Melee 1

≤11 1 damage

12-16 2 damage; taunted (EoT)

17+ 3 damage; taunted (EoT)

Signature Ability

Main Action

One creature or object per minion

🐭 Ready Rodent

Melee, Weapon

Melee 1

Triggered Action

One creature

Trigger: An ally deals damage to the target.

Effect: The scrapper makes a free strike against the target.

Radenwight Ratcrobat

Humanoid, Radenwight

Level 1 Platoon Harrier

EV 6

1S
Size7
Speed30
Stamina0
Stability3
Free StrikeImmunity: —
Movement: Climb

Weakness: —

Might -1**A**gility +2**R**eason 0**I**ntuition 0**P**resence +1**En Garde!** 2d10 + 2

Melee, Strike, Weapon

Melee 1

≤11 4 damage

12-16 6 damage

17+ 8 damage

Effect: The ratcrobat shifts up to 2 squares after striking the first target, then can shift 1 square after striking the second target.**Signature Ability**

Main Action

Two creatures or objects

Over Here, Thanks

Melee, Weapon

Melee 1

Maneuver

One creature

Effect: The ratcrobat slides the target up to 3 squares, then can shift into any square the target left.**Ready Rodent**

Melee, Weapon

Melee 1

Triggered Action

One creature

Trigger: An ally deals damage to the target.**Effect:** The ratcrobat makes a free strike against the target.**Gymratstics**

The ratcrobat gains an edge on strikes against larger creatures.

Cicero

Humanoid, Radenwight

Level 1 Platoon Support

EV 6

1S
Size5
Speed40
Stamina0
Stability3
Free StrikeImmunity: —
Movement: Climb

Weakness: —

Might 0**A**gility 0**R**eason 0**I**ntuition +2**P**resence +1**Piercing Trill** 2d10 + 2

Magic, Melee, Ranged, Strike

Melee 1 or Ranged 10

≤11 5 sonic damage; push 1

12-16 7 sonic damage; push 3

17+ 9 sonic damage; push 4

Effect: Cicero or one ally within distance regains Stamina equal to half the damage dealt.**Signature Ability**

Main Action

One creature or object

Vivace Vivace!

Area, Magic

3 burst

Maneuver

Each ally in the area

Effect: Each target who has used their Ready Rodent ability this round regains the use of their triggered action.**2 Malice:** The area increases to a 6 burst.**Ready Rodent**

Melee, Weapon

Melee 1

Triggered Action

One creature

Trigger: An ally deals damage to the target.**Effect:** Cicero makes a free strike against the target.**Musical Suggestion**

At the end of Cicero's turn, he can slide one adjacent creature up to 2 squares, ignoring stability.

Frenzied

Abyssal, Demon

Level 1 Minion Harrier

EV 3 for four minions

1M
Size6
Speed4
Stamina0
Stability1
Free StrikeImmunity: —
Movement: —Weakness: Holy 3
With Captain: +2 bonus to speed**M**ight 0**A**gility +2**R**eason -1**I**ntuition -1**P**resence -1**Rip and Tear** 2d10 + 2

Charge, Melee, Strike, Weapon

Melee 1

≤11 1 damage

12-16 2 damage

17+ 3 damage

Signature Ability

Main Action

One creature or object per minion

Soulsight

Any creature within 2 squares of the frenzied can't be hidden from them.

Ruinant

Abyssal, Demon

Level 1 Horde Harrier

EV 3

1M
Size6
Speed15
Stamina0
Stability1
Free StrikeImmunity: —
Movement: —

Weakness: Holy 3

Might 0**A**gility +2**R**eason 0**I**ntuition 0**P**resence +1**Bloodletting Claws** 2d10 + 2

Melee, Strike, Weapon

Melee 1

≤11 3 damage

12-16 4 damage

17+ 5 damage; **M** < 2 bleeding (save ends)**Signature Ability**

Main Action

Two creatures or objects

Salt Wounds 2d10 + 2

Magic, Ranged, Strike

Ranged 10

3 Malice

Maneuver

Three creatures

Special: Each target must be at less than full Stamina.

≤11 1 corruption damage

12-16 2 corruption damage

17+ 3 corruption damage

Lethe

While the ruinant is winded, they gain an edge on strikes, and any strike made against them gains an edge.

Soulsight

Any creature within 2 squares of the ruinant can't be hidden from them.



